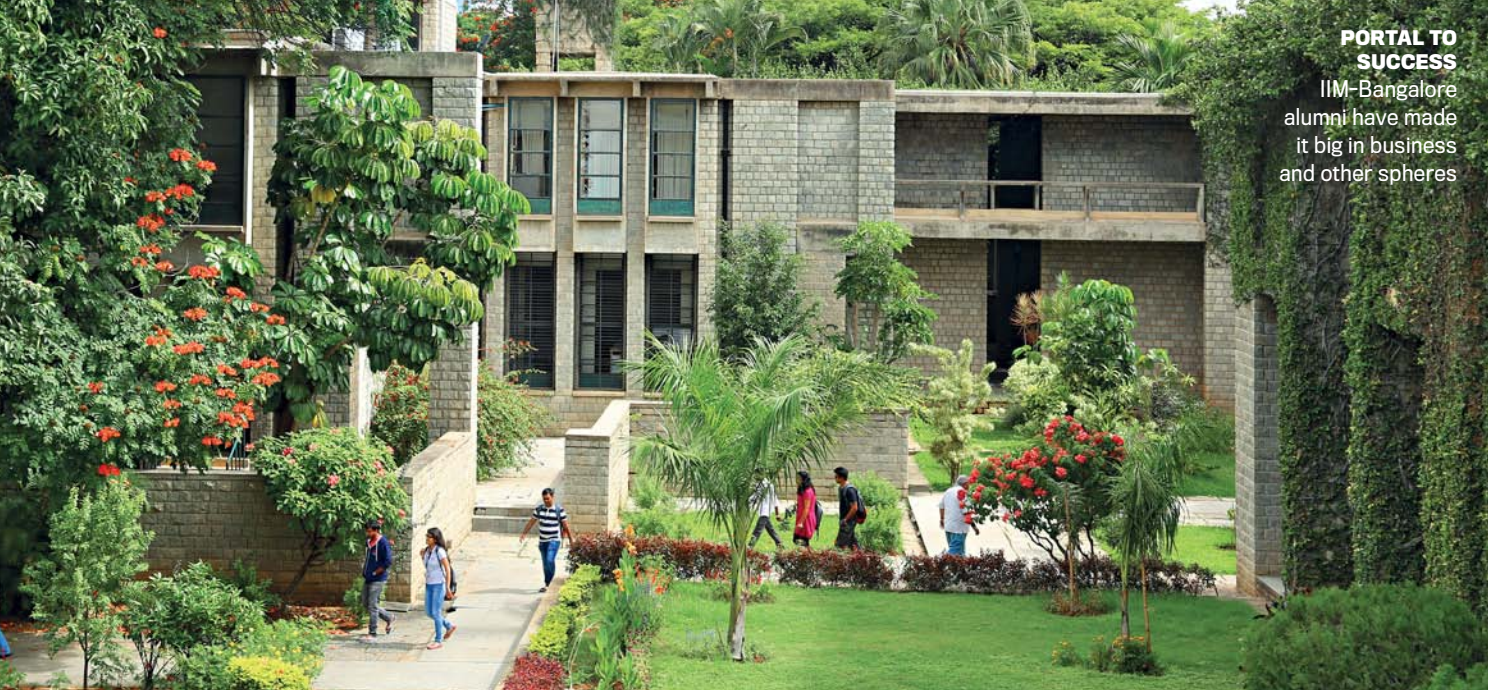


PORTAL TO SUCCESS
IIM-Bangalore alumni have made it big in business and other spheres

IIM-B fast-tracked our evolution as managers and leaders. Besides gathering distilled knowledge of management principles, techniques and skills, our perspectives and vision blossomed. And we learnt 'how to learn' about enterprises and environment, and how to look at any situation in a systemic and holistic manner with a long-time horizon. To me, that was the primary takeaway. This confluence of technology and management helped me shoulder decisive roles and responsibilities at ISRO from a manager to director to chairman, signing off with the Mangalyaan mission.

A specific gain from life at IIM-B were the lessons in institution-building. The new campus was in the conceptual stage. So, we also learnt about how to start an institution, seeing it happening there before us. Such lessons are not taught in books or classrooms. Let me elaborate: In 2000, I moved out of ISRO for a while to set up the Indian National Centre for Ocean Information Services (INCOIS) in Hyderabad. At INCOIS, we were starting from scratch—it was a new domain for me, with a new set of people and a new environment. I had just completed my PhD from IIT Kharagpur and went to the interview with a strategic plan. Within a couple of months, I could redefine the institution's vision and get the board to accept it. Originally planned as a data centre for the ocean, the institution was transformed into an information technology and knowledge enterprise. We shifted to a temporary location in Jubilee Hills while our new campus was being built. We wanted it to be a lean organisation with less than 100 people at any point of time. The IT boom was beginning and so I thought we must have a new culture in this new organisation. In two years, we became an internationally accepted institution and INCOIS became a key centre for the Indian Ocean region. In December 2004, the tsunami happened, and we rose up to become the tsunami-warning centre for India. ■

—as told to Ajay Sukumaran

The writer is a former chairman of ISRO. He graduated from IIM-B in 1976

TOP 10 PRIVATE B-SCHOOLS WITH BEST VALUE FOR MONEY

ROI RANK	NAME OF THE INSTITUTE	CITY	ROI
1	DEPARTMENT OF BUSINESS ADMINISTRATION, PRASAD V. POTLURI SIDDHARTHA INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY	Vijayawada	4.87
2	BHARATH INSTITUTE OF HIGHER EDUCATION AND RESEARCH	Chennai	4.83
3	PUNJAB COLLEGE OF TECHNICAL EDUCATION	Ludhiana	3.64
4	SAU LEENA KISHOR MAMIDWAR INSTITUTE OF MANAGEMENT STUDIES & RESEARCH	Chandrapur	3.53
5	LAKSHMI NARAIN COLLEGE OF TECHNOLOGY	Bhopal	3.50
6	DEPARTMENT OF MANAGEMENT STUDIES, EASWARI ENGINEERING COLLEGE	Chennai	3.21
7	DEPARTMENT OF MBA, CMR COLLEGE OF ENGINEERING AND TECHNOLOGY	Hyderabad	3.11
8	KALAIGNARKARUNANIDHI INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY	Coimbatore	3.09
9	PRESTIGE INSTITUTE OF MANAGEMENT AND RESEARCH	Indore	3.03
10	RUNGTA COLLEGE OF ENGINEERING & TECHNOLOGY	Bhilai	3.02

Note: ROI (return on investment) is calculated by dividing average domestic annual salary with fees for the entire course